

6 Scientific and historical-critical challenges, ethical living and the works of scholars	6.1	Scientific and historical-critical challenges – faith and history: the death and resurrection of Jesus in modern scholarship a) Context of scientific challenges to the resurrection as miracle; the challenge of the Enlightenment – resurrection as a fictional event, the resurrection as myth, the resurrection as an event in the experience of the disciples. b) The work of Ian Wilson and Frank Morison on the historical evidence for the resurrection of Jesus based on analysis of the different Gospel narratives and alternative explanations for the empty tomb. (8) (9) c) Context, comparison and the strengths and weaknesses of these views. Their significance for understanding the texts and their impact on other areas of study over time.
	6.2	How should we live? (10) a) Christian life: the ethical teaching of Jesus from the Sermon on the Plain in Luke 6 and other texts on the poor, outcasts, wealth and forgiveness, including the parables of the Lost (Luke 15), the Good Samaritan (Luke 10), the Rich Man and Lazarus (Luke 16). b) The relationship of the teaching of Jesus to that of Judaism at the time. Interpretations of this material for today, including religious and secular views, and the impact on Christian codes of living, including equality and pluralism. With reference to the ideas of I H Marshall and F Matera.

List of extracts for Paper 3: New Testament Studies

Students are expected to study a range of texts that support and underpin their knowledge and understanding. The assessment will include two extended-response questions on an excerpt, sourced from this extracts list. The following texts are **not** exclusive to the topic areas under which they appear; students will need to be able to apply these texts across any suitable topic area. These are published in the *A level Religious Studies Anthology: Paper 3 – New Testament Studies*, which can be downloaded from our website.

Suggested version of the Bible is the New International Version (NIV).

(1) Matthew 1:18–2:23

(2) John 1:1–18

(3) John 6:24–59, 8:12, 9:1–12, 10:1–21, 15:1–17

(4) John 2:1–11, 4:43–54, 5:1–15, 6:1–24, 9:1–12 and 11:1–44

(5) Luke 8:1–15, 11:14–32, 13:22–30, 14:15–24, 17:20–37, 18:18–30, 19:11–27

(6) John 2:12–25, 5:16–47, 7:25–52, 8:12–59, 9:13–34, 10:22–42, 11:45–57, 18:1–19:16

(7) Luke 23:26–24:53

(8) Morison F – *Who Moved the Stone?*, Chapter 8 Between Sunset and Dawn , pp.88–102 (Magdalene Press, 2015) ISBN 9781897384480

(9) Wilson I – *Jesus: The Evidence*, Chapter 10 Did Jesus Really Rise From the Dead?, pp.139–153 (Weidenfeld & Nicolson, 1996) ISBN 9780297835295

(10) Luke 6:17–26, 10:25–37, 15:1–32, 16:19–31

Assessment information

- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- The assessment is 2 hours.
- The assessment is out of 80 marks.
- The assessment consists of three sections.
- Students must answer all questions in Section A, Section B and Section C.
- The paper includes short-open, open-response and extended writing questions.
- See *Appendix 1* for the command words that will be used in the examination paper.
- Use of specialist language will be assessed as it is through the selection and deployment of specialist language and terminology that students are able to demonstrate their knowledge and understanding of religion and belief.

Synoptic assessment

Synoptic assessment requires students to work across different parts of a qualification and to show their accumulated knowledge and understanding of a topic or subject area.

Synoptic assessment enables students to show their ability to combine their skills, knowledge and understanding with breadth and depth of the subject.

Students will be able to demonstrate this through the extended essay in Question 4.

Sample assessment materials

A sample paper and mark scheme can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 3 Advanced GCE in Religious Studies Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs)* document.

Paper 4: Study of Religion

Overview

The content for this paper comprises a focused and in-depth study of a chosen religion. The study provides a foundation for understanding the key beliefs and values of a religion, recognising that 'belief' itself does not necessarily have the same role and emphasis in religions or between religions. The study helps students explore how believers attribute authority both to key people in the religious community and to various kinds of traditional, sacred texts. This study also explores various and diverse ways in which religious believers express their sense of identity through, for example, their most sacred rituals and their codes of behaviour. It gives students an opportunity to explore both common ground and diversity in the religious tradition. They will broaden their understanding through familiarity with the views of various contributors, from within and outside the tradition, who have studied this religion in some depth.

Students will deepen and extend their understanding of their chosen religion by studying an aspect of the way in which the religion has changed and developed over time, so that they increase their awareness of diversity within traditions. This aspect of development will reflect the particular focus, concerns, emphases and values of the tradition concerned. Further depth of study is provided by a study of key scholars who have made a significant contribution, either historically or in the present, to an understanding of what it means to be a follower of this religion. Further breadth is added by giving students the opportunity to explore the interface between the religion and contemporary society. Students will explore a passage of text that is influential in the tradition of this religion. **These studies will give students the opportunity to explore links between this paper and other areas of study, such as exploring common ground and diversity in the fields of philosophy and ethics.**

It is compulsory for students to compare the work of two named scholars, including a specific extract of their work. The list of extracts at the end of the paper must be studied by all students and this includes the work of two named scholars for comparison. These are published in the relevant pages of the *A Level Religious Studies Anthology*, which can be downloaded from our website. The context in which these texts could be studied is indicated by bracketed numbers in the detailed content, (1) for example. These extracts are **not** exclusive to the topic areas under which they appear; students will need to be able to apply these extracts across any suitable topic. This allows for a range of questions, including text or language specific, as well as thematic.

In this paper, students will be required to study the ideas of key contributors in relation to specific content areas. These are indicated against each relevant sub-topic. Students will be required to use these ideas to support and underpin their knowledge and understanding.

Overall, this study will give students the understanding and skills needed to be able to explore what it means to be a religious believer today, in the context of an increasingly diverse and secular society.

Students must study **one** religion from the following six options.

4A: Buddhism

4B: Christianity

4C: Hinduism

4D: Islam

4E: Judaism

4F: Sikhism